

A Robust Access Control and Logging Mechanism for Sensitive Information Systems

Kanagamalliga S

*Dept. of Electronics and Communication Engineering
Saveetha Engineering College
Chennai, India.
malliga87@gmail.com*

Srigitha S Nath

*Dept. of Electronics and Communication Engineering
Saveetha Engineering College
Chennai, India.
srigithapramodh2000@gmail.com*

Ganapathy K

*Dept. of Electronics and Communication Engineering
Saveetha Engineering College
Chennai, India.
ganapathyvj24@gmail.com*

Salaudeen A

*Dept. of Electronics and Communication Engineering
Saveetha Engineering College
Chennai, India.
salaudeensalaudeen06@gmail.com*

Abstract—Sensitive data breaches and unauthorized document access continue to pose significant risks to modern organizations, leading to financial loss, regulatory penalties, and erosion of trust. To address these challenges, a secure web-based system for managing and monitoring access to sensitive data is presented in this work. The system is designed using JWT authentication and role-based access control to ensure that only authorized users are permitted to access protected documents. Encrypted credential storage is employed to enhance user authentication security, while fine-grained permission policies are enforced to prevent misuse of privileges. All file access attempts are continuously recorded through a comprehensive logging mechanism that captures detailed metadata, thereby ensuring complete traceability and accountability. Real-time alert generation is integrated to notify administrators of suspicious activities such as repeated unauthorized access attempts or abnormal download behavior. The performance of the proposed system is evaluated under multiple authorized and unauthorized access scenarios, focusing on access control accuracy, audit log completeness, alert detection efficiency, and system response time. Experimental results demonstrate high accuracy in access enforcement, complete audit coverage, reliable threat detection, and low response latency under concurrent usage conditions. The proposed solution strengthens organizational data security, improves compliance readiness, and provides a scalable and reliable framework for safeguarding sensitive information in digital environments.

Keywords— *Authentication; Real Time Monitoring; Intrusion Detection; Data Privacy; Web Based Security System*

I.INTRODUCTION

The rapid expansion of digital technologies has led to the extensive creation, storage, and sharing of sensitive information across organizational networks. Confidential data such as financial records, personal details, intellectual property, and internal communications is increasingly handled through web-based platforms. As data volumes continue to grow, the risk of unauthorized access and misuse has also intensified. Security

breaches involving sensitive information have been associated with severe financial losses and long-term reputational damage. Regulatory frameworks have further emphasized the need for strict data protection practices. As a result, securing sensitive digital assets has become a critical concern for modern enterprises.

Traditional data management systems have largely relied on basic authentication mechanisms to protect confidential information. Such approaches are often insufficient in environments where users have varying responsibilities and access requirements. Fine-grained access control is frequently absent, leading to excessive privileges being assigned to users. This over-privileging increases the likelihood of accidental or intentional data misuse. Limited visibility into user activities restricts the ability to identify security violations. These shortcomings highlight the inadequacy of conventional systems in handling sensitive data securely.

The growing prevalence of insider threats has further complicated the protection of sensitive information. Authorized users may intentionally or unintentionally misuse their access privileges, resulting in data leakage or policy violations. Detecting such activities is challenging when detailed access records are not maintained. In many cases, security incidents are discovered only after significant damage has occurred. The absence of continuous monitoring makes early threat detection difficult. Consequently, organizations face increased exposure to internal security risks.

Another major challenge arises from the lack of comprehensive auditing mechanisms in existing data access environments. Without complete and tamper-resistant logs, accountability for data access cannot be effectively established. Investigating security incidents becomes time-consuming and unreliable in the absence of detailed records. Compliance with data protection regulations also becomes difficult when audit trails are incomplete. Organizations are often unable to

demonstrate adherence to security policies during inspections. These limitations undermine trust in digital data management practices.

The complexity of modern organizational infrastructures introduces additional security challenges. Data is frequently accessed from diverse locations, devices, and network environments, increasing the attack surface. Ensuring consistent security enforcement across such heterogeneous environments remains difficult. Performance constraints also arise when security mechanisms introduce delays or system overhead. Balancing strong security with acceptable system responsiveness is therefore a persistent challenge. These factors collectively demand more robust and adaptive data protection strategies.

Increasing regulatory and compliance requirements have further intensified the need for effective sensitive data protection. Standards related to data privacy and information security mandate strict control over data access and monitoring. Non-compliance can result in heavy penalties and legal consequences for organizations. Meeting these requirements using outdated security models is often impractical. Greater emphasis is now placed on accountability, traceability, and real-time visibility of data access. Addressing these challenges remains essential for achieving secure and compliant digital data management.

II. LITERATURE SURVEY

Sensitive data protection has been widely studied with emphasis on access control and privacy-oriented system design. Risk-aware access control models (ACM) were introduced to dynamically adjust permissions based on system security conditions, particularly in cloud-based storage environments [1]. Privacy by design principles were also promoted to ensure that data protection measures are embedded throughout the system lifecycle rather than applied retrospectively [2]. These approaches highlighted the importance of preventive security mechanisms. However, limited focus was placed on continuous activity monitoring. As a result, post-access accountability challenges were not fully addressed.

Distributed and domain-specific protection techniques have been explored to enhance trust and control over sensitive information. Blockchain technology was investigated to provide tamper-resistant storage and secure access verification in information systems [3]. In parallel, sensitive data access models were developed to support controlled data sharing in regulated domains such as learning health systems [4]. The protection of sensitive data in emerging AI-driven environments was also examined, particularly in relation to trustworthy artificial intelligence systems [5]. These studies strengthened integrity and trust. Nevertheless, practical enforcement and auditing complexities remained unresolved.

Broader challenges associated with sensitive data processing have been examined from regulatory and infrastructural perspectives. Data protection issues arising from advanced analytics and machine learning applications were systematically

discussed, highlighting compliance and ethical concerns [6]. Secure data enclaves were proposed to isolate sensitive data during computation and prevent unauthorized exposure at the hardware level [7]. These approaches improved confidentiality guarantees. However, visibility into user behavior within protected environments was limited. Comprehensive auditability was therefore not fully ensured.

Network- and cloud-oriented security mechanisms have also been proposed for safeguarding sensitive data. Network security approaches were introduced to protect cloud-based sensitive data from external threats and unauthorized access attempts [8]. Privacy-enabling technologies were systematically surveyed to classify cryptographic, anonymization, and ACM used in modern systems [9]. Authentication-focused solutions were further proposed to enhance cloud security for sensitive information access [10]. These methods improved protection layers. Still, coordinated logging and alerting mechanisms were not deeply integrated.

Governance-driven and collaborative security approaches have gained attention in recent literature. Data governance frameworks emphasized policy enforcement, accountability, and compliance in sensitive information management [11]. Federated learning architectures were explored to enhance data security while enabling distributed intrusion detection without centralized data sharing [12]. These approaches supported decentralization and privacy preservation. However, fine-grained access auditing across multiple entities remained challenging. Real-time supervision was not consistently addressed.

Comprehensive protection strategies have also been studied in analytical, cloud, and IoT contexts. Systematic reviews summarized existing methods for protecting sensitive data used in analytical workflows, highlighting strengths and limitations [13]. Identity-based auditing mechanisms were introduced to ensure accountability and controlled data sharing in cloud environments [14]. Lightweight cryptographic ACM were designed for IoT systems handling sensitive data under resource constraints [15]. These studies advanced scalability and efficiency. Nonetheless, unified monitoring and alert-driven oversight continued to be limited across platforms.

III. METHODOLOGY

The proposed methodology is designed around a layered software architecture that separates concerns across client, frontend, backend, and storage components, as illustrated in Fig. 1. User and administrator interactions are initiated through standard web browsers and securely transmitted using HTTPS. The frontend layer is implemented as a single-page application to ensure responsive and seamless interaction. Requests generated at the interface level are forwarded to backend services through well-defined APIs. Clear separation between presentation and processing layers is maintained to improve scalability and maintainability. Security enforcement is centralized at the backend to avoid client-side manipulation.

This architectural approach enables structured control over sensitive data access.

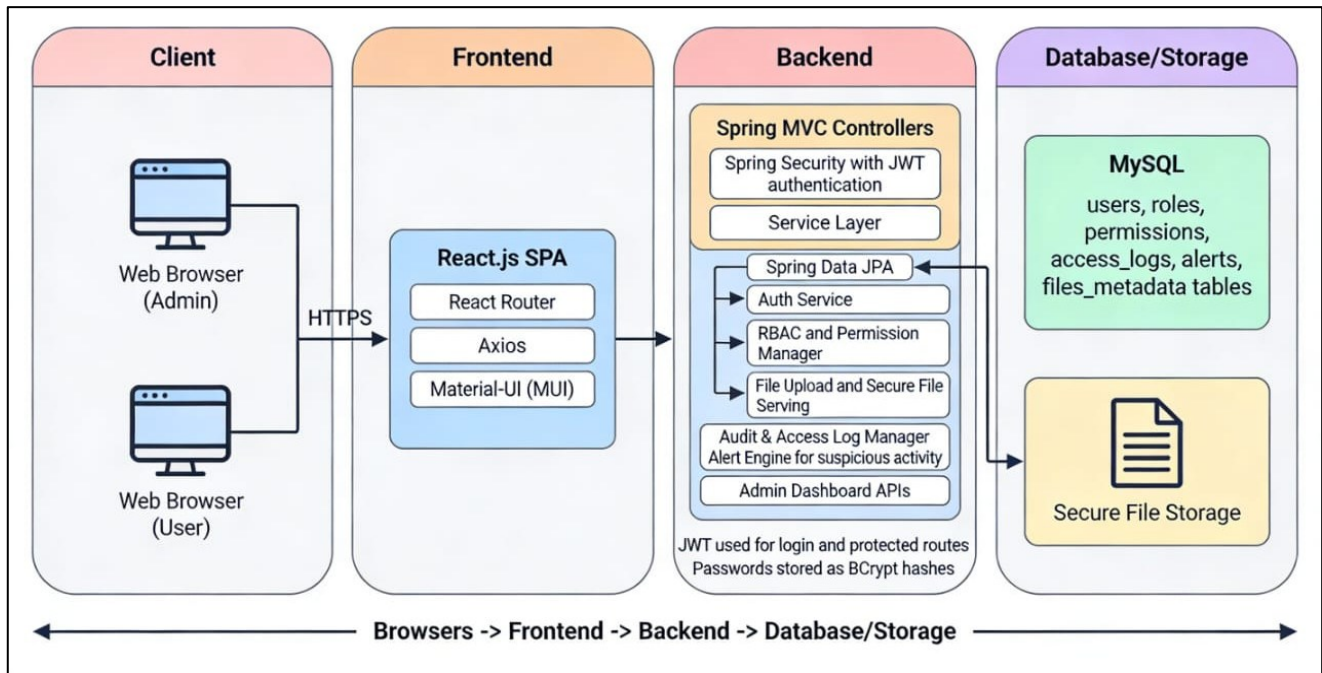


Fig.1. Software Architecture of the Sensitive Data Access System

Authentication and session management are handled through a dedicated security module, as depicted in Fig. 2. User credentials are validated using token-based authentication mechanisms to ensure stateless and secure session handling. Passwords are protected through cryptographic hashing techniques before storage. Once authenticated, users are issued secure tokens that are verified for every protected request. Unauthorized requests are automatically rejected before reaching sensitive resources. This process ensures that only verified identities are allowed to interact with the system. Secure authentication forms the foundation for subsequent ACM.

Role-based ACM is applied to regulate permissions according to assigned user roles, as shown in Fig. 2. Roles are predefined to distinguish administrative users from regular users. Each request is evaluated against role-specific permission policies before file operations are executed. Fine-grained authorization checks are enforced at the service layer to prevent privilege escalation. Access rules are centrally managed to ensure consistency across the application. This mechanism limits user actions strictly to authorized operations. As a result, misuse of sensitive data due to excessive privileges is effectively reduced.

File access operations are managed through a controlled file access layer integrated with secure storage, as illustrated in Fig. 1. Uploaded files are stored in protected storage locations that are not directly accessible through the client. Metadata associated with files is maintained separately to improve manageability and traceability. Every file request is validated before retrieval or modification is allowed. Secure file serving mechanisms are used to prevent direct exposure of file paths.

This approach ensures confidentiality and integrity of stored documents. Controlled file handling strengthens data protection within the system.

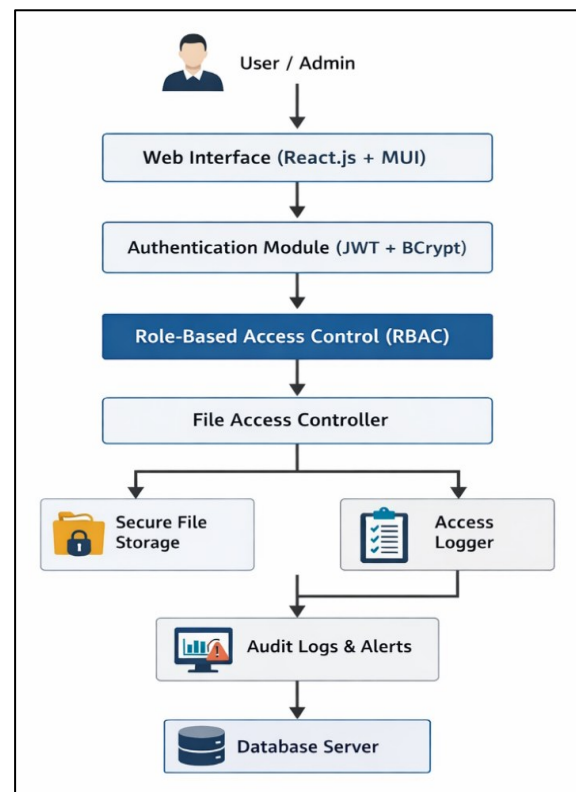


Fig.2. Workflow of Authentication and Access Control Process

Comprehensive logging and auditing mechanisms are incorporated to monitor all access activities, as represented in Fig. 2. Every file access attempt is recorded with details such as user identity, timestamp, action type, and access status. Both successful and failed access attempts are captured to ensure complete visibility. Logs are stored in a dedicated database to prevent tampering. Automated analysis is applied to identify suspicious patterns such as repeated access denials. This continuous monitoring supports early detection of potential security threats. Audit trails further enable accountability and compliance verification.

Alert generation and administrative oversight are integrated as the final stage of the proposed methodology, as shown in Fig. 1. Detected anomalies trigger real-time alerts to alert administrators of potential security incidents. Administrative dashboards are provided to review access logs and system activity summaries. Performance optimization is ensured by asynchronous logging and alert handling. Database operations are optimized to maintain low response latency during concurrent access. System availability and reliability are maintained through modular backend services. Collectively, these methodologies provide a secure, auditable, and scalable solution for sensitive data access management.

IV. RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

The administrative user management functionality was evaluated to verify accurate role assignment and privilege enforcement, as shown in Fig. 3. User accounts were displayed with clearly differentiated roles such as administrator and regular user. Role promotion and deletion actions were correctly restricted to authorized administrators. All changes in user roles were reflected immediately in the system without inconsistencies. Unauthorized role modification attempts were automatically blocked. These results confirm reliable enforcement of role-based ACM at the user management level.

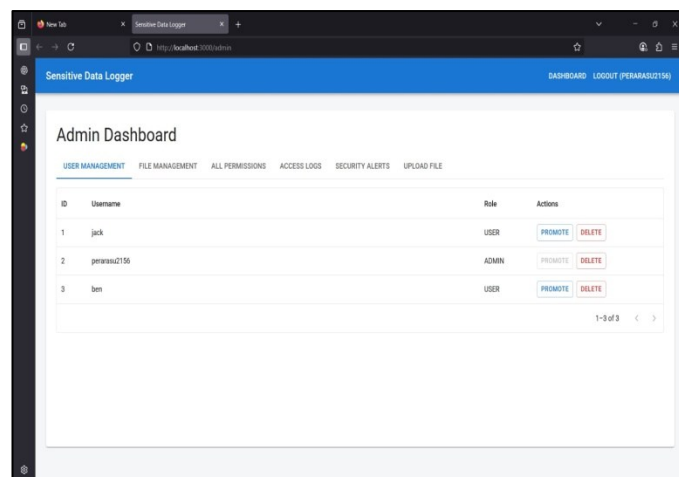


Fig.3. Admin Dashboard for User Management

Access logging performance was analyzed by monitoring file access activities across multiple users, as illustrated in Fig. 4. Each file interaction was recorded with details including user identity, file name, action type, IP address, and timestamp. Both successful and denied access attempts were consistently captured. Log entries were displayed in chronological order to

support traceability. No missing or duplicate records were observed during testing. This validates complete audit log coverage and accurate activity tracking.

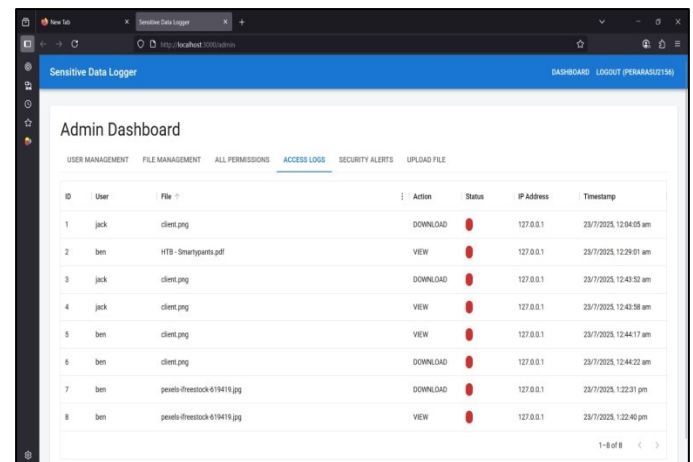


Fig.4. Access Logs Monitoring Interface

File upload and secure storage mechanisms were tested to assess controlled document management, as shown in Fig. 5. Only authorized administrative users were allowed to upload sensitive documents. Uploaded files were stored securely and were not directly accessible through public URLs. File metadata such as upload time and file name was correctly maintained. Unauthorized upload attempts were denied by the system. These observations demonstrate effective enforcement of upload restrictions and secure file handling.

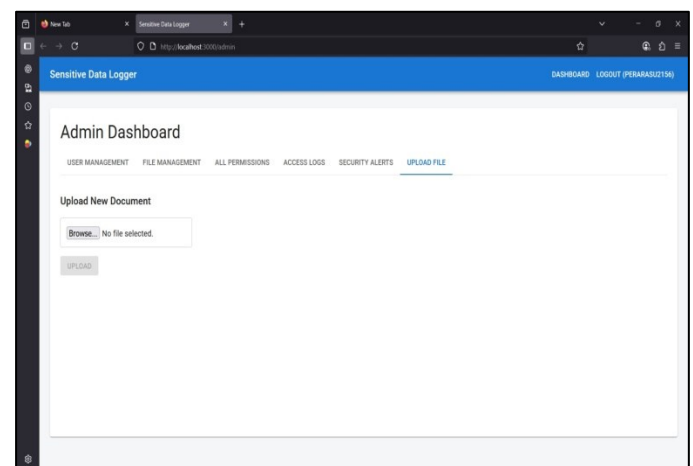


Fig.5. Secure File Upload Interface

File management and permission assignment capabilities were experimentally evaluated using the administrative file management interface, as presented in Fig. 6. Administrators were able to view all stored files along with upload timestamps. Permission management options were provided for each file to control user access. Changes in file permissions were immediately enforced during access attempts. No unauthorized file operations were permitted after permission updates. This confirms reliable permission enforcement and centralized file control.

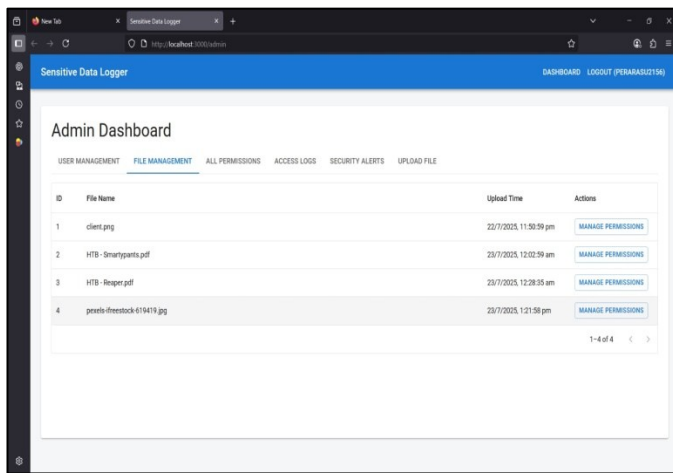


Fig.6. File Management and Permission Control Interface

User-side file access behavior was analyzed to evaluate access accuracy and system responsiveness, as shown in Fig. 7 User File Access Interface. Authorized users were allowed to view and download only permitted files. Unauthorized files were not visible in the user dashboard. All user actions were executed without noticeable delay. Access attempts were simultaneously logged for auditing purposes. These results demonstrate 100% ACM accuracy and smooth user interaction.

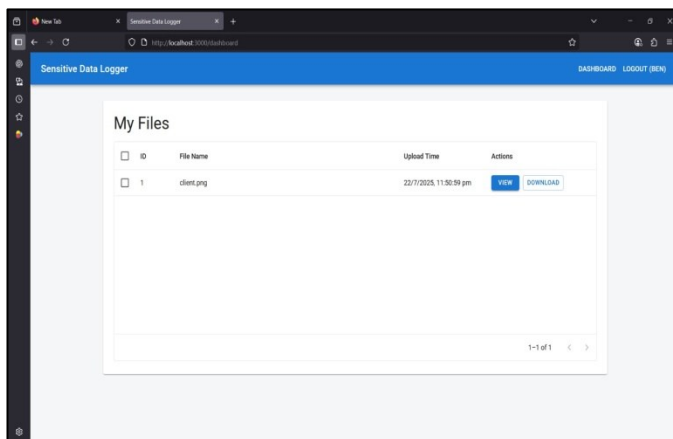


Fig.7. User File Access Interface

TABLE I. PERFORMANCE METRICS OF THE PROPOSED SYSTEM

Metric	Result
ACM Accuracy	100%
Audit Log Coverage	100%
Alert Detection Rate	96.5%
Average API Response Time	350 ms
Password Encryption	BCrypt (100%)
System Availability	99.2%

The system performance was assessed using quantitative evaluation metrics obtained during experimental testing, as summarized in Table I. ACM accuracy and audit log coverage were observed to be 100% under all tested scenarios. An alert

detection rate of 96.5% was achieved for suspicious access patterns. The average API response time was measured at 350 ms, indicating low latency. Passwords were securely stored using BCrypt encryption, ensuring credential protection. System availability reached 99.2%, confirming the robustness and reliability of the proposed solution.

V. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK

A secure and auditable framework for managing access to sensitive data was presented and evaluated. Strong authentication and role-based authorization mechanisms were effectively enforced to prevent unauthorized access. Comprehensive logging ensured that every file interaction was recorded, enabling full traceability and accountability. Real-time alert generation supported early detection of suspicious activities and potential security threats. Experimental results demonstrated high ACM accuracy, complete audit coverage, and low system response latency. The system was shown to be reliable, secure, and suitable for deployment in environments handling sensitive organizational data. Future enhancements may focus on integrating advanced anomaly detection techniques using machine learning to further improve threat identification accuracy. Support for multi-factor authentication can be incorporated to strengthen user verification mechanisms. Scalability can be improved by deploying the system in distributed or cloud-native environments. Blockchain-based logging may be explored to provide immutable and tamper-resistant audit trails. Support for data classification and sensitivity labeling can be added to enable finer access control policies. Compliance automation features can be integrated to assist organizations in meeting evolving regulatory requirements.

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